

## Bridging the Gap: Navigating Between Ideal & Actual Self



*“Knowing others is intelligence; knowing yourself is true wisdom.”*

**-Lao Tzu**

Deeply rooted in Psychology, the theory of [Ideal Self & Actual Self](#) talks about how a person's perception of themselves differs from the person they wish to be. **Actual Self** refers to who you truly are at this moment. It encompasses your current beliefs, behaviors, strengths, weaknesses, & experiences. **Ideal Self**, on the other hand, represents who you want to become. It includes your aspirations, dreams, values, & the qualities you wish to embody.

Consider the example of Mia, who views her actual self as someone who struggles with time management & often feels overwhelmed due to studies & extracurricular activities. But, in contrast, her ideal self is a disciplined & confident student who balances her academics, social life & hobbies effortlessly.

How can Mia bridge the gap between her actual self & ideal self that leaves her feeling anxious & frustrated? Mia can start using planners & time management apps, seek advice from peers, & set small, achievable goals. Over time, by developing better habits & gaining confidence, she will find herself closer to her ideal self, feeling more in control & fulfilled. This journey illustrates how the discrepancy between the actual and ideal self can drive personal growth & self-improvement.

## Why is it essential for Leaders to distinguish between their actual self & ideal self?

*As per a study by Psychology Today, around 85% of people deal with feelings of low self-worth & self-esteem.* Such people are more likely to have a hard time finding or keeping a job. This highlights the [importance for Leaders](#) to bridge the gap between their personal actual self & ideal self. When a Leader very well understands the relationship between the two, he/she can influence the lives of all around him/her. So, if you, as a Leader, need a little serotonin boost, this blog is just for you.

1. **Self-Awareness:** Recognizing the differences between the Actual Self & Ideal Self fosters greater self-awareness. This awareness can help Leaders identify strengths & areas for improvement.
2. **Motivation:** The Ideal Self can serve as a powerful motivator. It provides a vision of what's possible, inspiring Leaders to take action towards their goals. This way Leaders can strive for excellence & inspire others to do the same.
3. **Authenticity:** Leaders who acknowledge their actual selves can lead more authentically. Embracing their true selves fosters trust & respect within their teams, as they model vulnerability & honesty.
4. **Empathy & Connection:** Understanding their own struggles allows Leaders to empathize with team members facing similar challenges. This connection can enhance team dynamics & create a supportive work environment.
5. **Personal Growth:** Recognizing this difference encourages Leaders to pursue personal development. They can set specific goals to align their actual behavior with their ideal vision, enhancing their effectiveness.

## How Leaders can Bridge the Gap

Leaders can consider the following strategies for their teams:

1. **Set Realistic Goals:** *Setting realistic goals as a team helps to achieve around 90% higher performance.* Teams are made of individuals & individuals are imperfect. Leaders should be willing to understand this & set measurable goals for themselves & their teams. This makes the journey less overwhelming & also allows the team to celebrate small victories along the way.
2. **Reflect Regularly:** Taking some time to reflect on the progress the team has made so far will help Leaders to be better equipped in recognizing where each team member needs help.
3. **Seek Feedback:** As a [Leader](#), giving feedback would definitely be easy but it should also be easy to accept. Superiors or even team members can provide valuable insights into their strengths & areas for growth. External perspectives

can often help to understand how an individual is perceived versus how they want to be perceived.

4. **Practice Self-Compassion:** Leaders must embrace the journey of growth without harsh judgment. They should recognize that everyone has an Actual Self that is a work in progress & treat their team with kindness as they navigate this path.

## The Role of Society & Culture

It's essential for Leaders to acknowledge that societal & cultural influences can shape both the Ideal Self & Actual Self. Social media, cultural norms, & family expectations can create unrealistic standards, leading to feelings of inadequacy. Society sets norms that shape what is considered acceptable behavior, influencing individuals' perceptions of their actual & ideal selves. Cultural values shape ideals around success, leadership, & personal fulfillment. These values influence how individuals define their ideal selves & what they aspire to achieve.

The journey from Actual Self to Ideal Self is a personal & often non-linear process. Embracing both aspects can lead to profound self-discovery & growth. Leaders should always remember that the goal is not to reach perfection, but to grow & evolve themselves & their team into the best version of they can be—one step at a time.

Preparing to take on that **Leadership** role? Our experts can help you develop your own Leadership Brand. [Visit the BlewMinds Website right now.](#)

**Keywords:** Actual Self | Leadership | Compassion | Culture | Motivation

**Focus:** Actual Self

**Meta Description:** The journey from Actual Self to Ideal Self deals with self-discovery & growth. Learn how.